CLIENT PERSONAL AND BUSINESS FUNDING SEQUENCE

FP&A: Credit Stacking & Funding Sequencing Strategy

Which Bureau Will They Pull?

Experian, **Equifax** or **TransUnion**: the report a lender is most likely to check, state by state, and the order to apply in so approvals stack up.



355	670	204	3,003
original rows	outside datapoints	lenders	recorded pulls

Overview: Context, Sources and Limits

What this answers, where the data comes from, how it is updated and what it cannot tell you.



Context

Every hard inquiry lands on one of three credit reports. The same person can have a strong report at one bureau and a weak one at another, and no lender publishes which bureau it pulls by state.

Purpose

Forecast the bureau a lender will pull in each state, then turn that into an application order for personal and business funding.

Sources and Updates

Sources: a 355-row inquiry table from 16 states plus 670 outside datapoints from 56 cited sources: Doctor of Credit tables (2008 to 2019), the myFICO state grid (2023), 2025 to 2026 forum posts, MyBankTracker, CardRight, StackEasy and lender pages.

As of: October 7, 2026.

Updates: lender minimums are reviewed every quarter; each new datapoint reruns the cleaning, maps and model from the same scripts.

Data Limits

Consumer-reported: no lender publishes its bureau by state.

Uneven in age: most pulls are from 2008 to 2016; the newest are 2025 and 2026.

Thin states: under 10 pulls is a hint, not a finding.

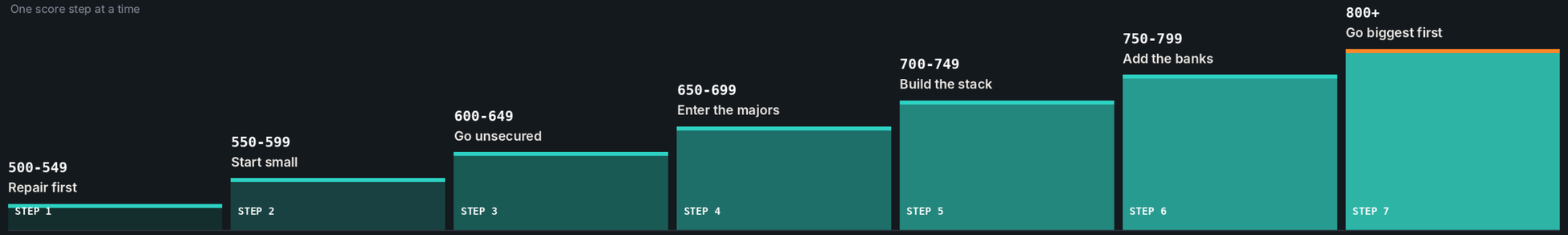
Not a promise: income, utilization and recent inquiries decide approvals. Not financial advice.

The Funding Ladder: One Score Step at a Time

Find your step by credit score, finish its moves, let the score rise, then climb. 57 (steps) across 7 (score ranges).

The Funding Ladder

One score step at a time



Fix errors, builder loan, trade credit. 8 (steps).

Prequalify, starter or secured card. 8 (steps).

Mainstream cards, credit union lines. 9 (steps).

Chase first at 670+, then Amex. 8 (steps).

0% business cards in 6 (rounds). 9 (steps).

Bank lines, SBA, personal loans. 8 (steps).

Largest bank facilities, then cards. 7 (steps).

Five Rules for Climbing

1. **Read your own reports first**
   Pull all three and note which bureau is cleanest.
2. **Spread inquiries across bureaus**
   One Experian-, one Equifax-, one TransUnion-leaning lender per round.
3. **Strictest rule first**
   Chase (5/24), Amex (2 cards per 90 days), then U.S. Bank, Wells Fargo, BofA.
4. **Soft pulls before hard pulls**
   Prequalify with Capital One, Discover, Amex, Upgrade or Fundbox.
5. **Business credit in parallel**
   Entity, EIN, D-U-N-S, business checking, 3 to 5 (net-30 vendors).

◆ WHAT EACH STEP LOOKS LIKE (from the 57-step funding sequence)

score_step	products	example_lenders	bureau_pulled	typical_limit
500-549 Repair first	Builder loan, secured card, net-30 vendors	Self, OpenSky, Navy Federal, Uline, Quill	No hard pull; Navy Federal: TransUnion	$200 to $2,000 (per account)
550-599 Start small	Starter and secured cards, microloans	Capital One, Mission Lane, Discover, Kiva	Capital One: all three; Mission Lane: TransUnion	$300 to $1,000 (per card)
600-649 Go unsecured	Unsecured cards, credit union lines, Fundbox	Discover, Synchrony, Navy Federal, PenFed	Discover: Experian; Synchrony: TransUnion; PenFed: Equifax	$500 to $15,000 (per account)
650-699 Enter the majors	0% business cards in rounds 7 to 14 days apart	Chase Ink, Amex Blue Business, Wells Fargo	Experian most often	$3,000 to $25,000 (per card)
700-749 Build the stack	Six-round 0% card stack, charge cards	Chase, Amex, U.S. Bank, Wells Fargo, BofA	Experian; U.S. Bank: TransUnion	$35,000 to $127,000 (whole stack)
750-799 Add the banks	Bank lines, SBA loans, personal loans	Chase, BofA, U.S. Bank, Huntington, LightStream	The bank's usual bureau; LightStream: TransUnion	$25,000 to $250,000 (per line)
800+ Go biggest first	Bank facilities, SBA 7(a), premium cards	Chase, BofA, Wells Fargo, SBA lenders	The bank's usual bureau; Capital One: all three	$50,000 to $250,000+ (per facility)

Market, Scope and Who It Serves

3,003 recorded bureau pulls, all lenders combined.

54%
Experian share of pulls

25%
Equifax share

21%
TransUnion share

38 of 49
states led by **Experian**

24
close-call states

In Scope

Bureau pulls: **Experian**, **Equifax** and **TransUnion**, every state and DC.

Funding types: cards, lines, loans, SBA, auto, equipment and real estate.

Lender facts: funding type, typical score and paperwork for 204 lenders (47 low or no doc).

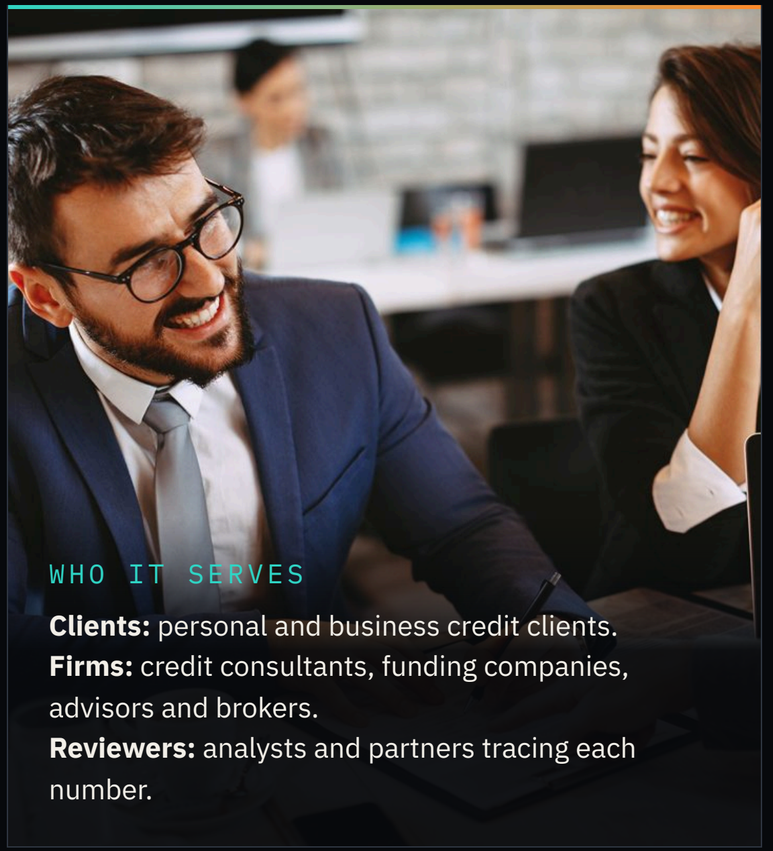
A sequence: an application order for seven score ranges, 500 to 800+.

Out of Scope

Business bureaus: D&B and similar files are not mapped.

Soft pulls and rates: prequalification and live rates are left out.

Advice: nothing here is legal, tax or investment advice.



WHO IT SERVES

Clients: personal and business credit clients.
Firms: credit consultants, funding companies, advisors and brokers.
Reviewers: analysts and partners tracing each number.

Ten KPIs With Formulas

Each formula worked with the October 7, 2026 numbers. The bar shows the worked value.

#	KPI	FORMULA	WORKED EXAMPLE	VALUE
KPI 1	**Bureau Share of Pulls**	pulls on one bureau in a state ÷ all bureau pulls there	Florida: 466 (**Experian** pulls) ÷ 885 (all pulls) = 53% (share)	**53%**
KPI 2	**National Share of Pulls**	one bureau's pulls ÷ all 3,003 pulls	1,616 (**Experian** pulls) ÷ 3,003 (all pulls) = 54% (share)	**54%**
KPI 3	**Lead Margin**	top share – second share, in points	Texas: 66% (**Experian**) – 17% (**TransUnion**) = 49 pts (lead)	**49%**
KPI 4	**Close Call**	a state whose lead margin is under 20 points	24 (close-call states) of 49 (states with data)	**49%**
KPI 5	**Issuer Bureau Habit**	an issuer's pulls on one bureau ÷ its pulls	American Express: 87% (of its pulls on **Experian**)	**87%**
KPI 6	**Predicted Likelihood**	multinomial logistic regression probability	Alabama: 43% (chance the pull is **Experian**)	**43%**
KPI 7	**Leader Stability**	refits of 150 where the leader holds	Connecticut: 95% (of 150 refits keep the leader)	**95%**
KPI 8	**Model Lift**	1 – model log loss ÷ baseline log loss	1 – 0.903 (model log loss) ÷ 1.041 (baseline) = 13% (lower error)	**13%**
KPI 9	**Cross-Check Result**	rows supported ÷ rows checkable	193 (rows checked), 0 (contradicted)	**100%**
KPI 10	**Lender Confidence Mix**	lenders at each level ÷ 204	39 (High), 104 (Medium), 61 (Low) of 204 (lenders)	**19%**

Data and Method

355 inquiries, cleaned, enriched and checked against 670 datapoints from 56 sources.



From One Table to a Checked Database

◆ 1. ORIGINAL TABLE

rows	355
states	16
columns	State, Bank and three bureau marks

◆ 2. CLEAN AND MATCH

spellings	229
lenders	102
unknown	11 kept and labeled

◆ 3. ENRICH

added	funding type
added	score needed
added	paperwork level

◆ 4. CROSS-CHECK

datapoints	670
sources	56
years	2008 to 2026

◆ 5. RESULT

confirmed	84 (+6 partly)
national fit	103
contradicted	0

How It Was Built: Extract, Transform, Load

◆ 1. EXTRACT

read	original workbook, All States & Banks tab
read	issuer state tables, 2008 to 2017
read	myFICO grid (2023) and 2025-2026 posts
read	lender pages for scores and rules

◆ 2. TRANSFORM

match	229 spellings to 102 lenders
normalize	x, blanks, counts to pulled or not
join	each row to outside data by lender and state
reshape	one row per state, lender and bureau

◆ 3. LOAD

excel	six-tab workbook with live totals
web	seven-page site on GitHub Pages
tableau	maps, regression and this story
model	weighted datapoints for the regression

Messy Data That Was Cleaned

Many spellings: 229 names matched to 102 lenders.

Mixed markers: x marks, blanks and counts up to 211 became pulled or not, with counts kept as weights.

Unknowns kept: 11 names are labeled, not forced into a match.

Cross-Check: 0 Contradicted

Confirmed	84
Partly confirmed	6
Fits national pattern	103
Contradicted	0

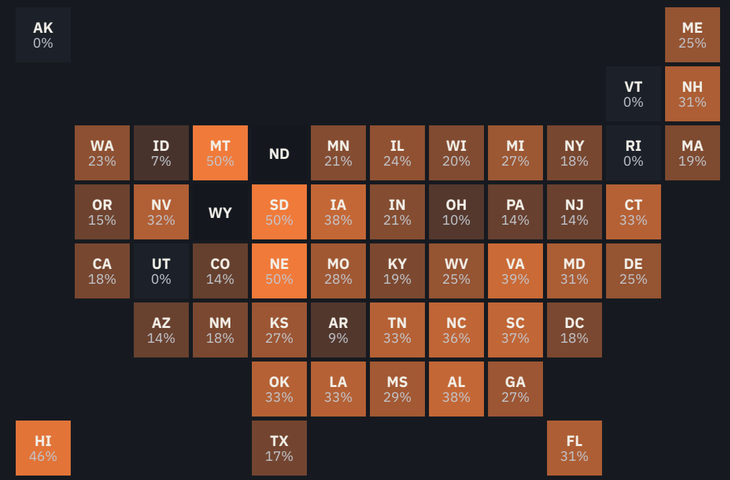
Share Maps: Where Each Bureau Is Pulled

Share = pulls on one bureau in a state ÷ all bureau pulls in that state. Brighter means a bigger share.

Experian Share of Pulls



Equifax Share of Pulls



TransUnion Share of Pulls



Florida, Experian

466 of 885 pulls (53%); big samples barely move.

Equifax belt

Virginia 39%, South Carolina 37%, North Carolina 36%.

TransUnion in Georgia

About 1 in 3 pulls (37 of 116).

Small Samples

Montana shows 0% **Experian** from only 2 pulls.

1. In Tableau, click a state
2. Its detail card opens beside the maps

Close Calls: The Model's Best Forecast

In 24 states the top two bureaus are within 20 points. Chips show **Experian**'s predicted likelihood for a typical application.

10 Clear lean

leader holds in 90%+ of 150 refits

CT 45% **DE** 50% **FL** 47%
IL 50% **IN** 55% **MD** 50%
MO 53% **NV** 56%
OK 42% **TN** 45%

5 Moderate lean

leader holds in 70%+ of refits

AL 43% **GA** 42%
KY 45% **LA** 41%
NC 46%

4 Toss-up

leader holds in under 70% of refits

HI 40% **KS** 39%
SC 38% **VA** 39%

5 Thin data

under 10 datapoints; national pattern shown

IA 55% **MT** 43%
NE 45% **SD** 48%
UT 47%

55%
held-out accuracy vs 50% for national shares

13%
lower error (log loss 0.903 vs 1.041)

150
refits to test each leader

Decision Tree: Which Lender, in What Order

Check the five overrides, follow your strongest report's branch, then apply in the Step 3 order.

Decision Tree: Which Lender to Apply to, and in What Order

Step 1 checks override everything. Then follow the branch for your strongest report. Step 3 sets the order.

◆ START: pull all three reports

then compare scores, errors and recent inquiries on each one

STEP 1: CHECK THESE FIRST

◆ IF your score is under 650

then start on ladder steps 1 to 3: fix errors, builder loan, secured or starter cards

◆ IF a report has errors

then dispute and fix it before applying anywhere that pulls that bureau

◆ IF a report has 3+ new inquiries

then route the next round to issuers that pull a different bureau

◆ IF you live in a close-call state

then check card 7; 4 (toss-up states) can land on any bureau

◆ IF you want business funding

then most business cards still check your personal report; plan it as a personal pull

STEP 2: NONE APPLY? FOLLOW YOUR STRONGEST REPORT

◆ IF EXPERIAN IS STRONGEST

why most-pulled bureau, 54% (of all pulls)

if 650 to 699 Chase first (5/24 rule), then Amex, 87% (Amex pulls on Experian)

if 700+ stack Chase, Amex, BofA 56% (on Experian), Wells Fargo

if in VA, SC or NC Equifax leans higher there, so stick to Amex and BofA

◆ IF EQUIFAX IS STRONGEST

why 25% (of all pulls); lead with it on purpose

if you want bank cards Citi 39% and Chase 36% (of their pulls on Equifax)

if you want credit unions Truist, PenFed, Citizens, Huntington lean Equifax

if in VA, SC or NC the Equifax belt: 39%, 37%, 36% (Equifax share of pulls)

◆ IF TRANSUNION IS STRONGEST

why least pulled, 21% (of all pulls), so pick lenders that lead with it

if you want store cards Synchrony, 62% (of its pulls on TransUnion)

if you want bank cards U.S. Bank 47% (on TransUnion), Barclays, Navy Federal

if in Georgia 37 of 116 (TransUnion pulls of all Georgia pulls) = 32%

STEP 3: THEN APPLY IN THIS ORDER

◆ 1. Strictest first

Chase (5/24), then Amex, U.S. Bank, Wells Fargo, Bank of America, regionals.

◆ 2. One per bureau per round

spread each round across Experian-, Equifax- and TransUnion-leaning lenders.

◆ 3. Soft pull, then hard pull

prequalify; apply for real only when the offer looks good.

◆ 4. Capital One last

it checks all three reports, so it goes after every other lender in the round.

◆ WHAT_IF: model's best forecast, four real cases

lender_in_state	forecast	chance_by_bureau
Amex in Kansas	Experian	84%
Chase in Florida	Experian	43% 37% 21%
Capital One in Virginia	Equifax	29% 45% 26%
Synchrony in Ohio	TransUnion	26% 65%

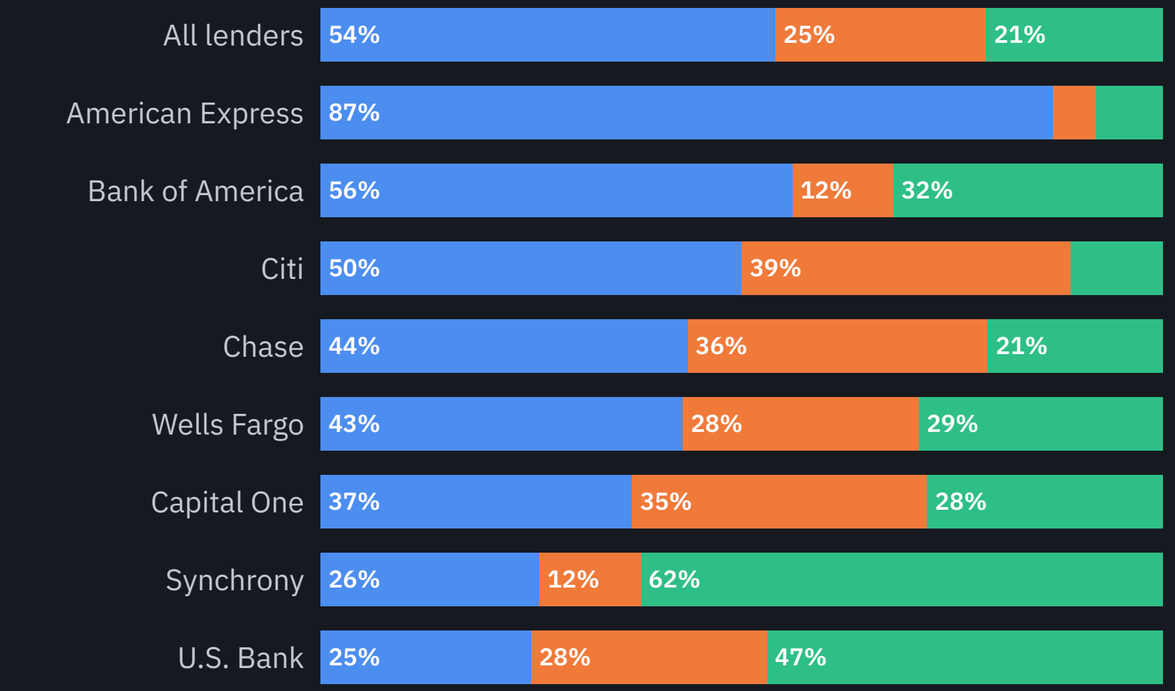
Every number says what it is in parentheses. Overrides come first; then the branch for your strongest report; then the order in Step 3.

Scorecard: Issuer Habits and Where the Numbers Come From

Each issuer's bureau habit (KPI 5), how every number was built and what the data cannot tell you.

Issuer Bureau Habits

Share of each issuer's recorded pulls: **Experian**, **Equifax**, **TransUnion**



Where the Numbers Come From

Sources: 56 (cited sources) plus the original 355-row (inquiry) table.

Clean: 229 (spellings) matched to 102 (lenders); every mark normalized.

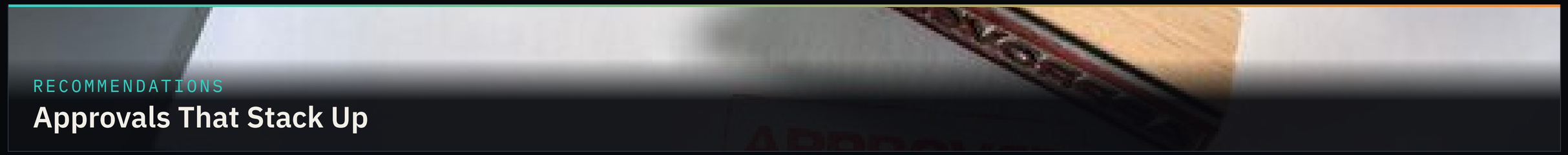
Check: 193 (rows checked), 0 (contradicted).

Model: multinomial logistic regression, 5-fold cross-validation, 150 (refits).

Limits: consumer-reported; most pulls from 2008 to 2016; likelihoods, not promises.

Recommendations: The Best Move for Each Stakeholder

Best move, when to choose it and the next move, for five stakeholder types.



RECOMMENDATIONS

Approvals That Stack Up

Personal Credit Clients

Best move: Pull all three reports, then apply where your strongest report gets pulled in your state.

Choose this when: one report is clearly stronger or cleaner.

Next move: check your lender on Tableau card 5; prequalify first.

Business Credit Clients

Best move: Treat business card applications as personal inquiries.

Choose this when: you apply for business cards as an owner.

Next move: build the business file in parallel; review the 47 (low or no doc) lenders.

Credit Consulting Companies

Best move: Plan disputes and inquiry spacing bureau by bureau.

Choose this when: a client's three reports disagree or carry errors.

Next move: fix the report target lenders pull first, then apply.

Business Funding Companies

Best move: Stack in strictest-rule order; spread each round across bureaus.

Choose this when: a client is at 700+ (credit score).

Next move: use the funding ladder and one lender per bureau group per round.

Funding Advisors and Brokers

Best move: Run the close-call check before advising.

Choose this when: the client lives in one of the 24 (close-call states).

Next move: in the 4 (toss-up states), plan for any bureau.

FP&A: Credit Stacking & Funding Sequencing Strategy

Which Bureau Will They Pull? Sources, as of October 7, 2026.

Key Sources

Doctor of Credit: Which Credit Bureau Does Each Card Issuer Pull?

myFICO Forums: Which Report Will They Pull, Part 2 (state grid)

MyBankTracker: Bank of America credit pull

CardRight: Which credit report each bank pulls

StackEasy: Credit bureau pull database 2026

myFICO: Do credit inquiries lower your FICO Score?

FTC: Five percent of consumers had errors (2013)

All 56 sources, cited by row

Live Now

Tableau Story: Which Bureau Will They Pull

Dashboard website

Code and data on GitHub

Next Steps

Log new inquiry datapoints and refit the model; resolve the 11 unidentified names; refresh lender minimums each quarter.